

YILAN ANNIE GAO

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PMP · CSM · M.Ed. · M.P.I.

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

- 12 years of cross-functional program management experience in high-stakes, fast-moving technology environments — with a consistent track record of driving company-wide alignment and structured response during critical moments, regulatory shifts, and high-visibility product events.
- Experienced at the intersection of product, Trust & Safety, and policy operations — translating complex compliance and safety requirements into clear cross-functional action plans, escalation workflows, and executive communications under pressure and tight timelines.
- Demonstrated executive presence and judgment in high-profile situations — regularly presenting to VPs and C-suite, synthesizing ambiguous, fast-moving information into clear recommendations and trade-offs for senior leadership.
- PMP and CSM certified; proven ability to build and document rapid response playbooks, escalation frameworks, and cross-functional processes from zero in ambiguous, high-consequence environments.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations | Roblox Corporation | San Mateo, CA *Feb 2023 – Present*

Trust & Safety Policy Operations & Rapid Response (2025–Present)

- Serve as primary cross-functional incident lead for compliance and policy events affecting Roblox's Top creator accounts — owning end-to-end response coordination across Engineering, Policy, Legal, Safety, and Moderation during rapidly shifting regulatory and safety cycles.
- Built Roblox's first false-moderation protection system from the ground up — defining escalation workflows, response playbooks, and cross-functional communication protocols across Safety, Policy, and Legal; directly reduced wrongful takedowns that threatened platform engagement and creator trust.
- Own developer communications during critical policy events, translating complex compliance requirements into clear, actionable guidance with speed and precision; participate in VP- and C-suite meetings to represent developer impact and align on strategic response under pressure.
- Drove GTM strategy and end-to-end rollout of an IP protection product under low internal prioritization — managing competing stakeholder priorities, resolving blockers, and onboarding the platform's top developer teams through a phased, feedback-driven launch.
- Manage 3 direct reports; resolved 600+ IP-related support tickets in Q1, identifying systemic patterns and translating insights into process improvements and resource planning decisions.

LiveOps — High-Stakes Event Operations & Incident Management (2024)

- Produced and program-managed 5 platform-wide live events each reaching 10M+ players — owning full-cycle execution in a high-velocity, zero-failure-tolerance environment; monitored real-time performance, managed incident escalations, and coordinated external vendors to ensure on-time, on-spec delivery.
- Synthesized real-time event data and post-event analytics into executive-level reports and strategic recommendations, framing trade-offs and prioritization decisions for senior leadership after each critical launch.
- Served as the central coordination hub across content, engineering, legal, and vendor stakeholders — anticipating blockers, managing dependencies, and ensuring unified response across teams during live execution windows.

International Expansion & Cross-Functional Operations (2023)

- Coordinated multi-regional developer programs across China, Japan, and Latin America; co-designed a structured developer feedback system embedding community insights into the global product development cycle upstream.
- Represented Roblox at international developer conferences; managed complex multi-stakeholder communications across cultures, time zones, and regulatory environments.

Senior Program Manager, Developer Relations | Roblox China | Shenzhen, China *Mar 2021 – Feb 2023*

- Strategy and operations lead reporting to VP of DevRel China; orchestrated cross-functional communications aligning China market priorities — including regulatory and compliance requirements — with Global HQ product and business strategies.
- Structured ambiguous local developer, compliance, and regulatory needs into prioritized, actionable recommendations for global engineering and policy teams under time pressure; built escalation frameworks that bridged US and China operational contexts.
- Designed and delivered executive-level briefings synthesizing market performance, developer trends, and operational data into decision-ready narratives that influenced Global HQ investment and resource allocation.

- Led negotiation with US Finance team to establish China's data access framework; defined GTM strategy for platform launch and built executive reporting infrastructure to track post-launch performance and flag emerging risks.

Partnership Programs Lead | California State University, San Bernardino | San Bernardino, CA *Apr 2019 – Apr 2021*

- Managed a portfolio of institutional partnerships with 100% program renewal rate; designed and delivered 4 recurring end-to-end programs totaling 130+ instructional hours with budgets exceeding \$4M USD.
- Led cross-functional strategic initiatives resulting in 23% improvement in client engagement; achieved 60% recruitment growth in year one through proactive stakeholder management.

China Programs Coordinator | Virginia Commonwealth University | Richmond, VA *Jul 2014 – Mar 2019*

- Built and managed 5 international education programs achieving 300% enrollment growth; coordinated complex multi-stakeholder relationships across 10+ campus departments and 20+ global partner institutions.

CERTIFICATIONS & SKILLS

Rapid Response & Crisis Operations: Escalation Workflow Design · Incident Management · Playbook Development · Trust & Safety Operations · Policy-to-Action Translation · Executive Briefing Under Pressure

Program Management: PMP (PMI) · Certified Scrum Master (CSM) · Cross-functional Leadership · Stakeholder Alignment · GTM Strategy · Risk Management · Executive Communication

Tools: Jira · Confluence · Tableau · SQL · Excel (advanced) · Google Suite

AI Tools: ChatGPT · Claude · Gemini — actively applied to workflow automation, rapid synthesis, and operational efficiency

Languages: English · Mandarin Chinese

EDUCATION

Master of Product Innovation — Virginia Commonwealth University *Dec 2018*

Master of Education — Adult Learning & Human Resource Development — Virginia Commonwealth University *May 2014*

Bachelor of Arts — English & International Relations — Sichuan International Studies University *Jul 2012*